

01 Get it

02 Trust it

03 Use it

04 Stretch it

MCP 101 · USE IT · BETTER HABITS WITH AI

Instead of this, *do this*

19 habit swaps for reps, managers and customer success, so your AI tool and Backstory do the gathering and you start from the answer.

People keep their old habits and *bolt Claude onto the end of them.*

Change the habit, and your AI tool stops being an extra step. It does the gathering, and you start from the answer. We use Claude as the example. ChatGPT, Copilot and other AI tools work the same way. **Small changes, big impact.**

01

Ask, don't gather

Instead of opening six tabs before a call, ask for the brief.

02

Pull live, don't paste

Instead of pasting CRM notes into Claude, let it pull them live, so nothing goes stale.

03

Be specific, not general

Instead of "How's my pipeline?", ask a question with a filter, a time window and a signal.

WHERE YOU TAKE ACTION · 1

In your AI tool, through Backstory MCP. Ask in Claude or any connected AI tool. One-account answers cover the last 30 days. Lists work by whose deals, close date, engagement and what's on the calendar ahead.

[One account or deal](#)[A list](#)

WHERE YOU TAKE ACTION · 2

Through Backstory's assistant. Start with "Ask Backstory's assistant" for deeper questions: the big themes, how a relationship has gone, an account history when you take one over, and anything older than 30 days. Name the period. It reaches about three months back reliably, so check key dates and figures against the deal record.

[Backstory's assistant](#)

ROLE 01 · HABITS TO CHANGE

Account executive

Prep, follow-up and deal strategy, without the tab hunt.

01 Before the call

Pre-call prep · Deal updates

02 Sharpen the question

Pipeline check · Stakeholder map · Deal risk

03 After the call

Follow-up email · Similar deals

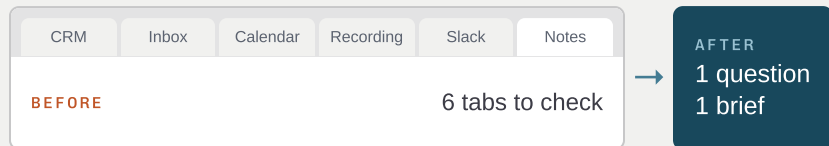


Ask for the brief. Let it pull live.

Two pre-call routines, side by side: the old habit, the prompt that replaces it, and why the new one sticks.

01 Pre-call prep

Ask, don't gather



INSTEAD OF

Opening six tabs before a call.

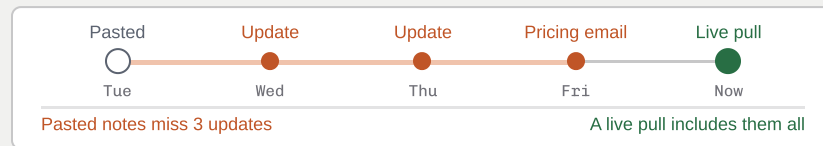
DO THIS · AI TOOL · ONE ACCOUNT

"Help me prep for my call with Vantage Retail."

WHY One ask replaces the hunt. The brief comes from the last 30 days of captured activity.

02 Deal updates

Pull live, don't paste



INSTEAD OF

Pasting CRM notes into Claude and hoping they're current.

DO THIS · AI TOOL · ONE ACCOUNT

"What's the latest on the Vantage Retail deal?"

WHY It's up to date with what Backstory has captured, so nothing goes stale.

Vague questions get vague answers

Name the account, or say whose deals and which window. Every answer becomes a to-do list.

03 Pipeline check

INSTEAD OF

“How’s my pipeline?”

DO THIS · AI TOOL · LIST

“Which of my deals closing this quarter have nothing on the calendar in the next 30 days?”

Whose: my deals

Close date: this quarter

Calendar: next 30 days

WHY IT WORKS

A short list of deals with no next meeting. Check Backstory read it as *your* deals.

04 Stakeholder map

INSTEAD OF

Rebuilding the buying group from memory.

DO THIS · AI TOOL · ONE ACCOUNT

“Using Backstory, who have we been talking to at Vantage Retail in the last 30 days, and when?”

WHY IT WORKS

The most engaged people and when you last spoke. Gaps in the buying group stand out.

05 Deal risk

INSTEAD OF

“Is this deal okay?”

DO THIS · AI TOOL · ONE ACCOUNT

“Any risks on the Vantage Retail deal?”

WHY IT WORKS

The same risks come back each time, so you can plan around them.



Start from what's captured, not from memory

06 Follow-up email

Ask, don't gather

INSTEAD OF

Copying meeting notes into an email and rewriting them as a recap.

DO THIS · AI TOOL · ONE ACCOUNT

"What next steps did we agree on for the Vantage Retail deal?" Then draft the follow-up from that list.

DRAFT

MOCK DATA

Subject: Next steps from Tuesday's demo

Thanks for the time, Jordan. As agreed: revised pricing by Friday, security review kickoff next week, and a working session with your ops team on the 14th.

WHY Start from the agreed steps. Check owners and dates before you send.

07 Precedent

Ask, don't gather

INSTEAD OF

Asking around for someone who's worked a deal like this.

DO THIS · AI TOOL · ONE ACCOUNT

"Have we had a deal like the Vantage Retail deal before? How'd it go?"

SIMILAR DEALS

MOCK DATA

Vantage Retail
Retail · \$95K · Closes
Dec 12



Northwind Goods

Won

Pinecrest Market

Won

Alder & Co.

Lost

WHY Finds similar deals at other customers. Treat them as examples: you may get a different set each time.



ROLE 02 · HABITS TO CHANGE

Sales manager

Forecasts, 1:1s and coaching, grounded in what reps actually did.

-
- 01 The weekly rhythm
Coaching focus · 1:1 prep · Forecast prep
 - 02 Inspect with structure
Deal inspection
 - 03 See across the team
Calendar gaps · Account themes
-



Swap the prep behind every standing meeting

Your week already has a rhythm. Anchor one prompt to each standing meeting, and prep becomes a habit instead of a scramble.

MONDAY · TEAM REVIEW

Coaching focus

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF

Coaching from gut feel on who's struggling.

DO THIS · AI TOOL · LIST

"Which of my team's accounts have engagement under 30?"

Coach from facts, not hunches. Backstory shows which accounts have low engagement, so you know where to spend time.

TUESDAY · 1:1S

1:1 prep

Ask, don't gather

INSTEAD OF

Asking the rep to walk through every deal.

DO THIS · AI TOOL · LIST

"What deals does Priya Shah have closing this quarter? Give me the risks and next steps on each."

Backstory has the status. The 1:1 can start at coaching instead of a deal-by-deal readout.

WEDNESDAY · FORECAST CALL

Forecast prep

Pull live, don't paste

INSTEAD OF

Exporting the pipeline to a spreadsheet.

DO THIS · AI TOOL · LIST

"Which of my team's deals closing this quarter have engagement under 50?"

Low-engagement deals surface before the call, so it runs on evidence, not a rep's recall. Forecast numbers stay in Backstory Forecasting.

Give the answer a framework you can coach against

04 Deal inspection

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF

“Is Halden Freight going to close?”

DO THIS · AI TOOL · ONE ACCOUNT

“What’s Backstory flagging on the Halden Freight renewal deal?” Then map the flags to your method.

WHY Backstory names the risks. Your framework turns them into specific gaps to coach.

Halden Freight · flags mapped to MEDDPIC

MOCK DATA

M	Metrics	Strong	Cost-per-mile target agreed
E	Economic buyer	Gap	CFO not engaged in 26 days
D	Decision criteria	Strong	Criteria shared in writing
D	Decision process	Partial	Procurement steps unclear
P	Paper process	Unknown	No legal contact yet
I	Identify pain	Strong	Fleet downtime costs confirmed
C	Champion	Strong	Dana Ruiz, VP Operations
C	Competition	Partial	Incumbent mentioned once

YOUR METHOD Swap in the methodology your team uses, such as MEDDIC, BANT, SPICED or Challenger.



Look ahead and look back, without the hunt

05 Calendar gaps

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF

Reading every call summary to find deals going cold.

DO THIS · AI TOOL · LIST

“Which of Priya Shah’s deals have nothing on the calendar in the next 30 days?”

NOTHING ON THE CALENDAR · NEXT 30 DAYS

MOCK DATA

Halden Freight		\$240K · closes Nov 14
Corvia Health		\$180K · closes Dec 2
Beacon Labs		\$120K · closes Dec 9
Kestrel Air		\$85K · closes Dec 18

WHY Looking ahead at the calendar catches deals before they go cold.

06 Account themes

Ask, don’t gather

INSTEAD OF

Relying on anecdotes for what’s been going on in a big account.

DO THIS · BACKSTORY’S ASSISTANT

“Ask Backstory’s assistant what the big themes have been with Halden Freight over the last 90 days.”

BIG THEMES · LAST 90 DAYS

MOCK DATA

- 01 Pricing pressure from finance
- 02 Fleet expansion timeline
- 03 Security review ahead of renewal

WHY For anything older than 30 days, start with “Ask Backstory’s assistant.” Themes come back undated.



ROLE 03 · HABITS TO CHANGE

Customer success

Handoffs, renewals and expansion, with the full account story on hand.

01 One account, four moments

Sales handoff · QBR prep · Renewal prep · Expansion

02 Catch signals early

Last contact · Book health



Corvia Health, from handoff to expansion

MOCK DATA

01

HANDOFF

Sales handoff

Pull live, don't paste

INSTEAD OF

A 30-minute handoff call to learn what was promised.

DO THIS · AI TOOL · ONE ACCOUNT

"What did we agree to do for Corvia Health, and who's on the hook?"

WHAT CHANGES

Start day one knowing every commitment

02

QBR

QBR prep

Ask, don't gather

INSTEAD OF

Building the QBR deck from a blank page.

DO THIS · AI TOOL · ONE ACCOUNT

"Summarize the last month with Corvia Health."

WHAT CHANGES

Walk in with the last month already summarized

03

RENEWAL

Renewal prep

Ask, don't gather

INSTEAD OF

Piecing the renewal story together the week before.

DO THIS · AI TOOL · ONE ACCOUNT

"Any risks on the Corvia Health renewal deal?"

WHAT CHANGES

Spot renewal risk while there's time to act

04

EXPANSION

Expansion

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF

"Any expansion opportunities?"

DO THIS · AI TOOL · ONE ACCOUNT

"Who's active at Corvia Health right now?"

WHAT CHANGES

New names show where to expand



See the drop-off while there's time to act

05 Quiet contacts

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF

Finding out your champion left when an email bounces.

DO THIS · AI TOOL · ONE ACCOUNT

"Who have we been talking to on the Corvia Health renewal, and when?"

CONTACT · LAST 30 DAYS

MOCK DATA

Dana Ruiz

Champion



Active

Sam Okafor

IT lead



Active

Lee Park

Exec sponsor



Slipping

Rita Gomez

Finance



Slipping

WHY Each person's last contact date shows who's slipping before the renewal.

06 Book health

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF

Scanning your book account by account.

DO THIS · AI TOOL · LIST

"Which of my team's accounts have engagement under 30?"

ONE FILTER, ONE SHORT LIST

MOCK DATA

Your book

48 accounts

Engagement under 30

12 accounts

Worth a call this week

3 accounts

WHY One filter turns a whole book into a short list. Then ask about the risks on each account that matters.



Get the right answer *the first time*

Six habits that make every prompt clearer. Follow the examples in this deck, and when an answer is right, save it as a skill so you get it every time.

Use the full company name

01

TRY

"Catch me up on Halden Freight."

Short names can match another account. The full name gets the right one.

HABIT Check the company name in the first answer.

Say whose deals and which window

02

TRY

"Using Backstory, what deals do I have closing this quarter?"

"My," "my team's" and a close date tell Backstory exactly what to pull.

HABIT Read how Backstory understood the list before you act on it.

Get the facts, then draft

03

TRY

"What next steps did we agree on for the Vantage Retail deal?"

Start from the agreed steps, then ask your AI tool to turn them into the follow-up.

HABIT Proof owners and dates before you send.

Ask for facts then make the call

04

TRY

"Any risks on the Halden Freight renewal deal?"

Ask the same question about each account, then compare them side by side yourself.

HABIT You decide which one needs attention.

Name the assistant and the period

05

TRY

"Ask Backstory's assistant what the big themes have been with Halden Freight over the last 90 days."

Older or deeper questions go to Backstory's assistant when you say so.

HABIT Name the period you want.

One question per chat

06

TRY

Start a new chat when the question changes.

Long chats are more likely to drift. A fresh chat keeps the answer focused.

HABIT New question, new chat.



How to phrase it for *the best answer*

Know what you want? Here's the phrasing, or the place, that gets you there fastest.

WHEN YOU WANT TO KNOW...

ASK IT THIS WAY

Which renewals or commit deals need attention

"Using Backstory, what deals do I have closing this quarter?" Then ask about the risks on each.

Which deals need a next meeting

"Which of my deals closing this quarter have nothing on the calendar in the next 30 days?"

How an account has gone over time

"Ask Backstory's assistant what the big themes have been with Halden Freight over the last 90 days."

How the forecast changed

Open Backstory Forecasting in the app for headlines and pipeline changes.

Which deals need you most

"Which of my team's deals closing this quarter have engagement under 50?" Then ask about the risks on each.

What's new on a deal

"What's the latest on the Halden Freight renewal deal?"

What's on tomorrow, or the latest email

Connect your calendar or email in the same AI tool, then ask alongside Backstory.



What changes as the habit sticks

Start with one prompt. Within a few weeks it's routine, and the time you used to spend gathering goes back to customers.

Account executive	Sales manager	Customer success
DAY 1 Prep one call by asking for a brief instead of opening tabs.	DAY 1 Prep one 1:1 from Backstory instead of a status readout.	DAY 1 Ask for the risks on one renewing account.
WEEK 2 Morning prep takes minutes. Follow-ups start from captured notes.	WEEK 2 Every standing meeting has a prompt. Forecast prep runs on evidence.	WEEK 2 Handoffs and QBR outlines start from what was captured.
MONTH 1 You ask sharper questions and spot quiet deals before they go cold.	MONTH 1 Coaching time goes to the deals that need a decision.	MONTH 1 Quiet contacts and book risk surface while there's time to act.

BEST PRACTICES TO KEEP

Name the account

Use the full company name and check it in the first answer.

Scope the ask

Whose deals, close date, engagement, calendar ahead.

Check the reading

For lists, confirm it says your deals and the right window.

Anchor it

Tie one prompt to a meeting you already run.



THE TAKEAWAY

Name the account. Scope
the ask. *Check the reading.*

Accounts, reps and deals shown are mock examples: Vantage Retail, Halden Freight, Corvia Health.

